



If one person in a relationship controls the other's spending, it gives the controlling person a parental type of power that's not healthy in a marriage, and can cause resentment to build in the spouse who has no financial power in the relationship.

Often there's one person in a marriage who is more interested, motivated, or adept at paying the bills, balancing the checkbooks, tracking expenses and investments, and maintaining a budget. Talk about it. You may both quickly agree on the obvious choice for these tasks or you may decide to share the responsibility. Regardless of who does what, sit down at least once a month and review your finances together.

Maintaining Credit in Your Own Name

Virtually all financial experts agree that after marriage you should maintain credit in your own name. Keep a credit card in your name only, and use it occasionally, but always pay off the balance each month. If you find yourself on your own through death or divorce, you'll have immediate credit available. It can be difficult to obtain credit for even the most basic needs, let alone a large purchase like a car or house, if you don't have a credit history that doesn't include your spouse.